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Method and system for measuring pressure in a body cavity

Abstract

A method includes receiving, from a primary pressure sensor, a pressure measurement indicative of a pressure of a patient cavity and controlling, by an insufflator, a supply of the insufflation fluid to the patient cavity based on the pressure measurement from the primary pressure sensor. The method further includes delivering, by a trocar, the supplied insufflation fluid to the patient cavity via an access port, wherein: the access port comprises a seal and a retractor; and the access port facilitates access therethrough to the patient cavity.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE (1) This nonprovisional application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/570,685 filed on Sep. 13, 2019, which is a continuation-in-part of U.S. application Ser. Nos. 16/206,284, 15/251,511, 15/610,026, and 16/271,072, which are incorporated by reference herein. application Ser. No. 16/206,284, entitled “Method and System for Controlling Pressurization of a Patient Cavity Using a Pressure Sensor of a Medical Appliance,” was filed on Nov. 30, 2018 and is a continuation-in-part application of U.S. application Ser. No. 15/610,026, entitled “Method and System for Controlling Pressurization of a Patient Cavity Using a Pressure Sensor in a Trocar,” which was filed on May 31, 2017. U.S. application Ser. No. 15/251,511, filed Aug. 30, 2016, is entitled “Method and System For Measuring Pressure in a Body Cavity Using a Trocar.” U.S. application Ser. No. 16/271,072, entitled “Method and System for Gas Maintenance to a Body Cavity Using a Trocar,” was filed on Feb. 8, 2019 and is a continuation-in-part application of U.S. Ser. No. 14/792,873, filed on Jul. 7, 2015, is entitled “Method and System for Gas Maintenance to a Body Cavity Using a Trocar.”

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates generally to medical procedures and more particularly to a method and system for measuring pressure in a body cavity.

BACKGROUND

(2) Laparoscopic surgery is a standard procedure in hospitals. Abdominal and chest cavity operations are being performed with instruments inserted through small incisions into interior portions of the body. Such laparoscopic procedures are now considered the treatment of choice for operations such as the removal of the gall bladder, spleen, adrenal glands, uterus, and ovaries. These laparoscopic procedures are accomplished via access through a device typically known as a trocar.

(3) A trocar facilitates the introduction of laparoscopic instruments into the abdomen or chest of the body. These instruments are typically introduced into regions under fluid pressure. Providing a fluid into a body cavity is referred to as insufflation, and the fluid (often a gas) is referred to herein as an insufflation fluid. The purpose of using such a device is to inflate or distend the body cavity to (1) allow the surgeon to explore the area in which the surgery will be performed and (2) provide a view of the site to be treated or observed. These trocars typically also allow for the insertion of an instrument via the innermost tube of the trocar. Examples of one or more trocars are provided in U.S. Pat. No. 8,715,219 (the '219 patent), U.S. Pat. No. 7,285,112 (the '112 patent), and U.S. Pat. No. 8,216,189 (the '189 patent), which are hereby incorporated by reference as if fully set forth herein.

(4) Often, insufflation is performed by providing a regulated pressurized insufflation fluid to the peritoneal cavity (or other desirable patient cavity) via a cannula of the trocar. This insufflation fluid, typically carbon dioxide, is supplied to a connection on the trocar tube by a flexible hose attached thereto by an insufflator.

(5) Accurate control of the pressure inside the body cavity is important because it can prevent loss of visualization through the scope during the surgical procedure. Loss of visualization can slow down the surgery and is also potentially dangerous for the patient as the sharp surgical instruments can no longer be seen by the surgeon.

SUMMARY

(6) According to one embodiment, a method of supplying insufflation fluid to a patient cavity includes receiving, from a primary pressure sensor, a pressure measurement indicative of a pressure

of a patient cavity and controlling, by an insufflator, a supply of the insufflation fluid to the patient cavity based on the pressure measurement from the primary pressure sensor. The method further includes delivering, by a trocar, the supplied insufflation fluid to the patient cavity via an access port, wherein the access port comprises a seal and a retractor and the access port facilitates access therethrough to the patient cavity.

(7) According to another embodiment, a system includes an insufflator, an access port, a primary pressure sensor, and a trocar. The insufflator includes a processor and a computer-readable media having logic stored thereon and is configured to supply insufflation fluid to a patient cavity. The access port includes a seal and a retractor and is configured to facilitate access therethrough to the patient cavity. The primary pressure sensor is configured to determine a pressure measurement indicative of a pressure of the patient cavity and the trocar is configured to receive the insufflation fluid supplied by the insufflator and deliver the insufflation fluid to the patient cavity via the access port. Furthermore, the insufflator is communicatively coupled to the primary pressure sensor and the logic stored on the computer-readable media is configured, when executed on the processor, to: receive the pressure measurement from the primary pressure sensor; and control the supply of the insufflation fluid to the patient based on the pressure measurement from the primary pressure sensor.

(8) The teachings of the disclosure provide one or more technical advantages. Embodiments of the disclosure may have none, some, or all of these advantages. For example, the systems and methods described herein may permit real-time pressure sensing in applications where pressure sensing is extremely critical. One such application is a transanal minimally invasive surgery (“TAMIS”) procedure. As another example, in some embodiments, a method and apparatus for measuring pressure in a patient cavity is provided that allows more accurate assessment of the pressure in a patient cavity due in part to the proximity of the pressure sensor to the patient cavity. Also, it is out of the gas flow stream which can create inaccurate pressure readings.

(9) Other advantages will be apparent to those of skill in the art.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) For a more complete understanding of embodiments of the disclosure and the potential advantages thereof, reference is now made to the following written description taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings, in which:

(2) FIG. 1A is a schematic diagram illustrating the control of pressure in a body cavity according to a traditional approach, and FIG. 1B is a graph illustrating pressure versus time for an example operation of the system of FIG. 1A;

(3) FIGS. 2A and 2B are schematic diagrams of a system for measuring pressure in a body cavity using a trocar;

(4) FIG. 3 is a cross sectional diagram of an alternative embodiment of the system of FIGS. 2A and 2B, showing an example cross section of a trocar;

(5) FIGS. 4A and 4B illustrate an alternative embodiment of a system for measuring pressure in a body cavity using a trocar with an outer tubular member having first and second channels (also referred to herein as “chambers”);

(6) FIG. 5 is a flow chart illustrating a method for measuring pressure in a body cavity using a trocar;

(7) FIG. 6 is a schematic diagram showing a trocar having an associated pressure sensor, the distal end placed in the abdominal cavity of a patient;

(8) FIGS. 7A and 7B are block diagrams illustrating additional details of components of the system of FIG. 6 that may be used to effect pressure determination and resulting actions;

- (9) FIG. 8 is a flow chart illustrating a method that includes switching control of an insufflator to be based on pressure measurements of a backup pressure sensor; and
- (10) FIG. 9 is a schematic diagram showing a multiple access port having an associated pressure sensor, wherein the multiple access port provides access to the abdominal cavity of a patient;
- (11) FIGS. 10A and 10B illustrate one embodiment of a system to supply an insufflation fluid to a patient cavity that uses a trocar having an inner lumen and an outer lumen in which the outer lumen allows for the insufflation fluid to be delivered to the patient cavity and the inner lumen provides a path for smoke to be removed from the patient cavity;
- (12) FIGS. 11A and 11B illustrate one embodiment of a system to supply an insufflation fluid to a patient cavity that uses a trocar having an inner lumen and an outer lumen in which the inner lumen allows for the insufflation fluid to be delivered to the patient cavity and the outer lumen provides a path for smoke to be removed from the patient cavity;
- (13) FIGS. 12A and 12B illustrate one embodiment of a system to supply an insufflation fluid to a patient cavity that uses a trocar having an inner lumen and an outer lumen with a plurality of chambers in which one of the chambers in the outer lumen allows for the insufflation fluid to be delivered to the patient cavity and the other chamber in the outer lumen provides a path for smoke to be removed from the patient cavity;
- (14) FIGS. 13A and 13B illustrate one embodiment of a system to supply an insufflation fluid to a patient cavity that uses a trocar having an inner lumen and an outer lumen with a plurality of chambers in which one of the chambers in the outer lumen allows for the insufflation fluid to be delivered to the patient cavity and the other chamber in the outer lumen allows pressure measurement of the patient cavity;
- (15) FIGS. 14A and 14B illustrate one embodiment of a system to supply an insufflation fluid to a patient cavity that uses a trocar having an inner lumen and an outer lumen with a plurality of chambers in which one of the chambers in the outer lumen allows for the insufflation fluid to be delivered to the patient cavity, the other chamber in the outer lumen provides a path for smoke to be removed from the patient cavity, and the inner lumen allows pressure measurement of the patient cavity;
- (16) FIGS. 15A and 15B illustrate one embodiment of a system to supply an insufflation fluid to a patient cavity that uses a trocar having an inner lumen and an outer lumen in which the outer lumen allows for the insufflation fluid to be delivered to the patient cavity and the inner lumen allows pressure measurement of the patient cavity;
- (17) FIGS. 16A and 16B illustrate one embodiment of a system to supply an insufflation fluid to a patient cavity that uses a trocar having an inner lumen and an outer lumen with a plurality of chambers in which one of the chambers in the outer lumen allows for the insufflation fluid to be delivered to the patient cavity, the other chamber in the outer lumen allows pressure measurement of the patient cavity, and the inner lumen provides a path for smoke to be removed from the patient cavity.
- (18) FIG. 17 is a schematic diagram of a system for delivering insufflation fluid to a patient cavity via a trocar and an access port; and
- (19) FIG. 18 is a flow chart illustrating a method for delivering insufflation fluid to a patient cavity using the system of FIG. 17.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(20) The teachings of certain portions of the present disclosure recognize that controlling pressure in a body cavity may be effected more advantageously by measuring a pressure through a pressure sensor disposed within a trocar disposed within the body cavity and providing the measured pressure to a controller that can appropriately supply pressurized insufflation fluid to the body cavity. Measuring pressure using a pressure sensor disposed within the trocar provides a more accurate indication of the pressure in the body cavity and can alleviate pressure control problems that may be experienced through other techniques. Example embodiments are best understood by

referring to FIGS. 1A through 18 of the drawings and the description below, like numerals being used for like and corresponding parts of the various drawings.

(21) FIG. 1A is a schematic diagram illustrating the control of pressure in a body cavity according to a traditional approach, and FIG. 1B is a graph illustrating pressure versus time for an example operation of the system of FIG. 1A. FIG. 1A shows an insufflator 10 connected to a patient, or body, cavity 20 through conduit 12 and a trocar 14. FIG. 1A also illustrates an alternative conduit 18, through which pressure can be measured.

(22) It is desirable to control the pressure within body cavity 20, referred to as P_c , during an operation. One traditional approach for such pressure control is to provide an insufflation fluid to body cavity 20 by insufflator 10, through conduit 12 and trocar 14. In some implementations, insufflator 10 operates on an on/off basis, and the pressure P_c in body cavity 20 is desirably controlled based on the actual pressure P_c in body cavity 20. The traditional control approach, however, is to control supply of insufflation fluid from insufflator 10 to body cavity 20 based on a pressure P_1 , measured at insufflator 10. This pressure P_1 is the pressure where conduit 12 meets insufflator 10, and thus serves as a proxy for pressure P_c in patient cavity 20. Due to pressure losses between insufflator 10 and patient cavity 20, the measured pressure P_1 is not the same as the actual pressure P_c in patient cavity 20, particularly since pressurized insufflation fluid is provided by insufflator 10 through conduit 12. As an alternative traditional method, separate conduit 18 is used to measure P_2 , which is the pressure where conduit 18 meets insufflator 12. Unlike conduit 12, pressurized insufflation fluid is not provided through this conduit 18. Thus, P_2 is a better indication of the pressure P_c in patient cavity 20 than P_1 is. Nevertheless, both approaches are not as accurate as may be desired and can lead to undesirable results, such as those shown in FIG. 1B. Further, pressure control can become inaccurate or inoperable if conduit 18 becomes clogged or disconnected. In FIG. 1B, pressure fluctuations over time are shown that can result from both of these traditional control procedures. These fluctuations occur due to differences between the actual P_c in body cavity 20 and P_1 and P_2 . At high leak rates in the patient cavity they can prevent loss of visualization thru the scope during the surgical procedure. Loss of visualization can slow down the surgery, and is also potentially dangerous for the patient as the sharp surgical instruments can no longer be seen by the surgeon.

(23) According to the teachings of the present disclosure, better pressure control of the pressure in a patient or body cavity can be achieved through use of a pressure sensor disposed in a trocar in the patient cavity, such as trocar 116 of FIGS. 2A and 2B. Disposing a pressure sensor in the trocar allows measurement of pressure at a location much closer to the patient cavity and therefore provides a better basis for determining the actual pressure in the patient cavity, and thus better pressure control.

(24) FIGS. 2A and 2B illustrate one embodiment of a system 100 for controlling pressure P_c in a patient or body cavity 120. System 100 includes a trocar 116, an insufflator 110, a conduit 175 for supplying insufflation fluid to a portion of trocar 116, a pressure sensor 180 disposed within trocar 116, and a conductive connection 182, providing an electrical connection between pressure sensor 180 and insufflator 110. A distal end 184 of trocar 116 is inserted into patient cavity 120 while the proximal end 122 allows an instrument 124 to be inserted such that trocar 116 provides access to body cavity 120 for the instrument 124. Suitable seals may be positioned in or around trocar 116 for preventing or reducing leakage of fluid out of trocar 116. Patient cavity 120 may be accessed through an incision made with an obturator, which may be included in the same kit or package with trocars described herein.

(25) Trocar 116 is formed with an inner tubular member, or inner lumen, 108 and an outer tubular member, or outer lumen, 110 in this embodiment. However, trocars without separate inner and outer lumens may also be used. Inner lumen 108 is separated from outer lumen 110 by an inner wall 125. Outer lumen 110 is surrounded by an outer wall 118. Outer wall 118 may be formed with one or more holes or apertures 114 near a distal end 162 of trocar 116. Insufflator 110 is a source of

insufflation fluid and may include appropriate control functionality for adjusting the supply of insufflation fluid, such as in response to receiving signals indicative of the pressure in the body cavity. A surgical instrument **124** may be positioned within inner lumen **108** to allow access to patient cavity **120** by a surgeon using surgical instrument **124**. Electrical connection **182**, which may be an electrical wire or any other suitable form of electrical connection, can be disposed in any suitable location within trocar **116**, including in inner lumen **108** or outer lumen **110**. Placement of electrical connection **182** primarily within outer lumen **110** provides an additional advantage of protecting electrical connection **182** from possible damage by instrument **124**.

(26) According to the operation of one embodiment, insufflation fluid **102**, which in one embodiment is carbon dioxide, is delivered by insufflator **110** to patient cavity **120** through conduit **175** and outer lumen **110**, as indicated by arrows **112**. Insufflation fluid **102** enters patient cavity **120** via apertures **114** in outer wall **118** of the trocar **116**. Pressure is measured by pressure sensor **180** within inner lumen **108** of trocar **124**, providing an approximation of the pressure P_c within body cavity **120**. The measured pressure is communicated to insufflator **110** through electrical connection **182** through outer lumen **110**, in this example. In one embodiment, pressure sensor **180** electrically couples to electrical connection **182** through apertures, although other forms of electrical coupling may be used, including wireless coupling. Based on the measured pressure, insufflator **110** may adjust the pressure P_c in body cavity **180** by, for example, providing or not providing additional insufflation fluid **102** to body cavity **120** or by adjusting the pressure or valve flow at which insufflation fluid **102** is provided by insufflator **110**. Any desired form of control may be used by insufflator, including on/off control, P, P-D, and P-I-D control approaches. By measuring the pressure near the body cavity P_c through a pressure sensor disposed within trocar **116**, better control of the pressure within body cavity **120** can be achieved, and undesirable cycling such as that shown in FIG. 1B can be reduced.

(27) Additional details and embodiments of systems and methods for providing pressure control of the pressure in a patient cavity are described below. FIG. 3 illustrates example details of portions of the system of FIGS. 2A and 2B, according to one embodiment. FIGS. 4A and 4B illustrate an alternative embodiment of a system for measuring pressure in a body cavity using a trocar with an outer tubular member having first and second channels, while FIG. 5 illustrates a method for controlling pressure in a body cavity.

(28) FIG. 3 is a cross sectional diagram near the distal end **184** of one embodiment of a trocar **216** that may be used in the system of FIGS. 2A and 2B. Similar parts to those of trocar **116** have like reference numerals. As illustrated, trocar **216** includes at least one cutout region **218** into which pressure sensor **180** may be disposed. Placement of pressure sensor **180** in cutout region **218** protects pressure sensor **180** from damage that may occur when an instrument, such as instrument **124**, is placed within inner lumen **108** of trocar. In this example embodiment cutout region **218** also protrudes into an area where the outer lumen **110** would otherwise be formed. The dotted line **224** forming part of cutout region **218** represents the missing portion of a generally circular inner lumen that would be formed without cutout region **218**. Thus, this is one example of a configuration of cutout region **218** in which disposing pressure sensor **180** within cutout region **218** would make pressure sensor **180** generally inaccessible to an instrument **124** with a generally cross sectional area to protect pressure sensor **180** from damage. The cutout regions **218** also ensure that the obturator and/or instruments do not close off the inner lumen **108** from being in intimate contact with the body cavity **120**.

(29) In this embodiment, passages **220** between inner lumen **108** and outer lumen **110** are provided to allow gas flow in the event that inner lumen **108** becomes blocked, as indicated by arrows **117**.

The passages **220** and cutoffs **218** prevent closing off the pressure sensor from the body cavity **120**.

(30) FIGS. 4A and 4B illustrate another embodiment of a system **300** for controlling pressure P_c in a patient cavity **320** that uses a trocar having an inner lumen and an outer lumen with a plurality of chambers. System **300** is analogous to system **100**, including a trocar **316**, an insufflator **310**, a

conduit **312** for supplying insufflation fluid to a portion of trocar **316**, a pressure sensor **380** disposed within trocar **316**, and a conductive connection **382**, providing an electrical connection between pressure sensor **380** and insufflator **310**, with analogous portions of system **100** and system **300** having like reference numerals but trocar **316** is analogous to trocar **116**, with analogous portions having analogous reference numerals, except that trocar **316** is formed with an inner lumen **308** and an outer lumen **310** having a plurality of chambers **330**, **332**. Outer wall **318** is formed with one or more holes or apertures **314** near a distal end **362** of trocar **306** that are associated with chamber **330**. Outer wall **118** may also be formed with one or more holes or apertures **315** proximate distal end **362** of trocar **306** that are associated with chamber **332**. Conductive connection **382** may be disposed primarily in chamber **330**, **332** of out lumen **310**, in inner lumen **308**, or in other suitable locations.

(31) Providing separate chambers **330** and **332** in outer lumen **310** allows placement of pressure sensor **380** in one of the outer chambers **330**, **332** and allows supplying insufflation fluid in the other outer chamber **330**, **332**. This protects pressure sensor **380** from damage that could potentially be caused by instrument **124** due to insertion into inner lumen **108**, while at the same time isolates pressure sensor **380** from supplied insufflation fluid **312**, which might otherwise adversely affect the accuracy of the pressure measured by pressure sensor **380**. In general, measuring pressure by pressure sensor **380** in a location within trocar **380** that does not also provide a conduit for insufflation fluid allows a more accurate estimation of P_c in patient cavity **320** because flow of gas creates a pressure drop along its path. This pressure drop required for gas to flow would create inaccurate pressure readings at the pressure sensor **380**.

(32) FIG. 5 is a flowchart illustrating a method of controlling pressure in a patient cavity. At step **410**, a trocar is disposed into a patient cavity. In some embodiments, the trocar may be formed with an inner tubular member and an outer tubular member. In some of these embodiments, the outer tubular member may be formed with multiple separate chambers and in some embodiments the outer tubular member has only one distinct chamber. A pressure sensor is located within the trocar. In some embodiments the pressure sensor may be located in the inner tubular member or the outer tubular member. In some embodiments the pressure sensor is located near a distal end of the trocar, near the patient cavity, and also located in a location inaccessible to a surgical instrument that is inserted into the inner tubular member. At step **420**, the surgical instrument is inserted into the trocar. At step **430**, a pressure is measured by the pressure sensor disposed within the trocar, which is indicating of a pressure in the patient cavity. At step **440**, based at least in part on the measured pressure, an insufflation fluid is supplied to the patient cavity by providing the insufflation fluid through the trocar. In one example, the pressure in the patient cavity can be increased by supplying more insufflation fluid or by supplying insufflation fluid at a higher pressure. Conversely, the pressure in patient cavity can be reduced by halting or reducing the flow of insufflation fluid or by reducing the pressure at which the insufflation fluid is supplied. The above steps may be performed in any desired order and may not necessarily be performed sequentially. For example, the pressure may be measured before, after, and/or during insertion of the surgical instrument. As another example, insufflation fluid may be supplied before, during, and/or after pressure measurement.

(33) Thus, the systems of FIGS. 2A through 5 provide more accurate control of pressure in a patient cavity through use of a pressure sensor disposed within a trocar.

(34) Additional details of systems **100** and **300** are described below for insufflation fluid **102**, insufflation fluid source **170**, trocars **116** and **316**, open gas tubing connection **120**, connection **164**, conduit **175**, conduit **185**, and surgical instrument **124**.

(35) Insufflation fluid **102** may be any suitable gas used for insufflation purposes. In one example, insufflation case is carbon dioxide. Insufflation fluid source **170** may be any suitable source of insufflation fluid **102** at any suitable pressure.

(36) Trocars **116**, **216**, and **316** may be any suitable as described herein. All trocars described herein may be open or closed at the distal end, as the application of the trocar would allow. Further,

the trocars may or may not include apertures in their inner wall separating the outer lumen from the inner lumen. Further, all trocars described herein may be formed according to features described in the '219 patent, the '112 patent, and/or the '189 patent. Further, trocars **116** and **316** may be formed with a heater and/or humidifier therein.

(37) Conduit **175** may be any suitable conduit for providing an insufflation fluid to a portion of a trocar. An example of conduit **175** includes flexible PVC tubing.

(38) Conduit **185** may be any suitable conduit for providing a vacuum to a portion of a trocar. An example of conduit **185** is flexible PVC tubing.

(39) Surgical instrument **124** may be any suitable instrument that may be used in surgery, including an obturator used to make an incision to obtain access to a body cavity. Modifications, additions, or omissions may be made to systems **100**, **300** without departing from the scope of the invention. The components of these systems may be integrated or separated. Moreover, the operations of these systems may be performed by more, fewer, or other components.

(40) In addition to measuring a pressure indicative of a pressure of a patient cavity via a sensor positioned within a trocar, this disclosure recognizes certain benefits of measuring patient cavity pressure using multiple sensors positioned in, on, or through one or more medical appliances. As will be described in further detail with respect to FIGS. **6-9**, insufflation fluid may be supplied to a patient cavity based on pressure measurements sensed by one or more of a primary pressure sensor and a backup pressure sensor as described in U.S. application Ser. Nos. 16/206,284 and 15/610,026.

(41) FIG. **6** is a schematic diagram showing the distal end **6024** of a trocar **6014** placed in the abdominal cavity **6020** of a patient. In general, an insufflator **6010** supplies insufflation fluid through conduit **6012** and trocar **6014** to patient cavity **6020**. Trocar **6014** allows insertion of a surgical instrument **6028** into patient cavity **6020**.

(42) Trocar **6014** has a primary pressure sensor **6022** on or associated with the trocar **6014**. The location can be anywhere in, on, or through trocar **6014** or associated with trocar **6014**; however, as described in greater detail below, in one embodiment primary pressure sensor **6022** is located on the exterior of trocar **6014** such that changes of pressure within trocar **6014** due to supply of insufflation fluid to patient cavity **6020** do not affect the pressure measured by primary pressure sensor **6022**. In some embodiments, primary pressure sensor **6022** is an absolute pressure sensor that can measure pressure in patient cavity **6020** (if disposed within patient cavity **6020**) or in the room in which the associated operation is taking place.

(43) Primary pressure sensor **6022** is coupled to insufflator **10** through any suitable technique, including a wired connection **6025** or a wireless connection. Primary pressure sensor **6022** supplies pressure data to insufflator **6010**. Insufflator **6010** uses this pressure data to control the supply on insufflation fluid by insufflator **6010**. In particular embodiments, this may include determining the change in height of trocar **6014** relative to changes in cavity pressure and thus the resulting change in height of patient cavity **6020**, as described in greater detail in co-pending application Ser. No. 15/293,013 entitled Method and System for Controlling Pressurization of a Patient Cavity Using Cavity Distension Measured by a Pressure Sensor of a Trocar incorporated herein by reference. Additional details of certain portions of FIG. **6** are described below.

(44) Insufflator **6010** may be any suitable source of insufflation fluid at any suitable pressure and may include a pressurized gas source. Insufflator may adjust the supply of insufflation fluid to patient cavity **6020** by adjusting the pressure and/or the volume of insufflation fluid supplied to patient cavity **6020**. Insufflator may include appropriate hardware and/or software for processing signals indicative of pressures measured by primary pressure sensor **6022** and processing such signals to convert them into useful information, such as converting them into pressures, heights, and/or other data that can be used control the flow of insufflation fluid to patient cavity **6020**, and further for processing such data to determine a desired pressure and/or volume of insufflation fluid supplied to patient cavity **6020** and for effecting such delivery.

(45) Conduit **6012** may be any suitable conduit for providing an insufflation fluid to a portion of a trocar. An example of conduit **6012** includes flexible PVC tubing. The insufflation fluid may be any suitable gas used for insufflation purposes. In one example, insufflation case is carbon dioxide.

(46) Trocar **6014** may be any suitable trocar through which insufflation fluid may be supplied to a patient cavity. Examples of one or more trocars are provided in U.S. Pat. No. 8,715,219 (the '219 patent), U.S. Pat. No. 7,285,112 (the '112 patent), and U.S. Pat. No. 8,216,189 (the '189 patent), which are hereby incorporated by reference as if fully set forth herein. Trocar **6014** may have a single lumen or may be formed with an inner tubular lumen and an outer tubular lumen such that insufflation fluid may be supplied through one of the lumens but not the other. Further, any of the lumens may be divided into multiple, separate chambers, such that gas in one chamber does not enter the other chamber. Examples of the above multiple lumens and multiple chambered trocars are described in U.S. application Ser. No. 14/792,873, entitled "Method and System for Gas Maintenance to a Body Cavity Using a Trocar," which is hereby incorporated by reference. Trocar **6014** may be open or closed at the distal end **6024**, as the application of the trocar would allow.

(47) Primary pressure sensor **6022** may be any sensor capable of sensing pressure or a change in pressure. Primary pressure sensor **6022** may measure absolute pressure or a pressure relative to some other pressure. In some embodiments, primary pressure sensor **6022** is an absolute sensor that can measure pressure in patient cavity **6020** (if disposed within patient cavity **6020**) or in the room in which the associated operation is taking place. In particular embodiments, primary pressure sensor **6022** can measure absolute barometric pressures with an accuracy of less than 1 Pascal pressure and therefore have the ability to measure the relative changes in altitude of close to one inch. Such pressure sensors are readily available in the marketplace.

(48) FIGS. 7A and 7B are block diagrams illustrating additional details of components of the system of FIG. 6 that may be used to effect pressure measurement and resulting insufflator control. FIG. 7A illustrates additional details of insufflator **6010**, according to one embodiment. In this embodiment, insufflator **6010** includes a memory **6040** and a processor **6042** communicatively coupled to the memory **6040**. Memory **6040** stores a pressure application **6044**, which may include logic for effecting pressure and altitude determination as described with respect to the other FIGURES as well as control of the supply of insufflation fluid to patient cavity **6020**. According to the teaching of the disclosure, a backup pressure sensor **6026** is provided. In one embodiment, insufflator **6010** includes a backup pressure sensor **6026**. Backup pressure sensor **6026** may be used to measure pressure associated with trocar **6014** in the event or problems associated with primary pressure sensor **6022**, as described in greater detail below in conjunction with FIG. 8. In another embodiment, backup pressure sensor **6026** is provided on trocar **6014**, as illustrated in FIG. 6. The teachings of the disclosure recognize that primary pressure sensor **6022** may experience problems due to being located a larger distance from an associated processor, which leads to potential for erroneous readings and interference. In addition exposing primary pressure sensor **6022** to contamination, such as from blood and to humidity also contribute to potential problems being experienced by primary pressures sensor **6022**. Backup pressure sensor **6026** may be any suitable pressure sensor, including the pressure sensors described above as being suitable as primary pressure sensor **6022**.

(49) FIG. 7B illustrates an alternative embodiment of the system of FIG. 6 in which an insufflator **6110** includes only standard features and is communicatively coupled through a connection **6114** to a pressure module **6112**. Pressure module **6112** includes components analogous to those described with respect to FIG. 2A, including a backup pressure sensor **6126**, but are included in this stand-alone pressure module. Connection **6114** between insufflator **6110** and pressure module **6112** may be wired or wireless. It will be understood that although a software-based system is illustrated in FIGS. 7A and 7B the logic described herein could instead be implemented through hardware circuits or a combination of hardware and software.

(50) FIG. 8 is a flow chart illustrating a method **6200** that includes use of a primary pressure sensor

and a backup pressure sensor associated with a trocar. The method may utilize structural items such as those described in FIGS. 6 through 7B or may use alternative structural items. Computational steps described below may be performed by any suitable computation device, including insufflator **6010** and pressure module **6112**, for example.

(51) The method begins at step **6202**.

(52) At step **6204**, at least a portion of a trocar having a primary pressure sensor is positioned in a patient cavity. The pressure sensor is located on, or associated with, the trocar such that the primary pressure sensor can provide a direct measurement of a pressure in a patient cavity when a portion of the trocar is positioned in the patient cavity. At step **6206**, the primary pressure sensor repeatedly measures a pressure within the patient cavity and communicates a signal indicative of the measurement to a processor associated with an insufflator. Also at step **6206**, the processor analyzes the measured pressure for indications of whether the signals indicative of the measured pressure being inaccurate or otherwise suggesting that the primary pressure sensor is operating in a less than optimal manner. Any suitable factors may be considered in such analysis; however, certain factors that may indicate the primary pressure sensor is operating in a less than optimal manner include (1) whether the received signal is not within an expected range for the received signal; (2) whether error data is received, such as whether errors have occurred due to interference from a power signal, the wrong number of bits have been received, data is received in the wrong format, or data is received with improper spacing (3) whether proper acknowledgment bits are not received from the primary pressure sensor, (4) whether the received signal is not within an expected voltage range, (5) whether expected new updated status bits are not received, such as whether a signal has changed enough to indicate a new measurement has occurred as opposed to a signal being so close to a previous signal to indicate no new measurement has occurred; and (6) in the case of two or more pressure sensors located on or near trocar **6014**, whether measurements by the two or more sensors are not within a certain range of each other.

(53) At step **6208**, a processor determines, whether the above analysis suggests the primary pressure sensor is not measuring accurately or otherwise not operating in a less than optimal fashion. If not, then processing returns to step **6206**, and if so, the control by the insufflator is switched to be based on pressure sensed by a backup sensor at step **6210**.

(54) Although the pressure sensed by a backup pressure sensor **6210** is usually not as accurate a measure of the pressure within the patient cavity and as such not as desirable for use in controlling an insufflator associated with a trocar, when problems arise with a primary pressure sensor positioned on or associated with a trocar such that the direct pressure measurements within a patient cavity can be made, it can be advantageous to at least temporarily switch control to be based on pressure measurements made by a backup pressure sensor located at the insufflator.

(55) Upon completing step **6210**, the method **6200** may conclude.

(56) Thus, a method and system have been described that uses backup pressure sensor for pressure measurements associated with an insufflator when it is determined that pressure measurements associated with a primary pressure sensor may be inaccurate. By doing so, advantages associated with locating a pressure sensor nearer the patient cavity may be realized.

(57) Although one embodiment has been illustrated and described in detail, it will be understood that various substitutions and alterations can be made therein without departing from the spirit and scope of the present invention, as defined by the following claims. For example, although primary pressure sensor **6022** has been described above as being located on trocar **6014**, primary pressure sensor **6022** may be located on, in, or through other medical appliances as well. Such medical appliances may be or include one of: a needle (e.g., veress needle, fistula, Huber, spinal), a stapler, a grasper, a pair of scissors, a scalpel, a cutter, an electrode, an end seal, a probe, a multiple access port, and a single access port. Although this disclosure identifies certain types of medical appliances (including trocars **6014**), this disclosure recognizes that primary pressure sensor **6022** may be located on, in, or through any suitable medical appliance. For example, this disclosure

recognizes any medical appliance that can puncture the skin as a medical appliance.

(58) FIG. 9 illustrates primary pressure sensor **6022** being part of or added to a medical port. A medical port may be single access or multiple access. As suggested by their names, a single access port includes one access point by which to introduce fluids and/or medical instruments into a patient and a multiple access port includes more than one access point by which to introduce fluids and/or medical instruments into a patient. FIG. 9 illustrates a particular type of multiple access port known as a GelPort. As will be understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art, a GelPort Laparoscopic System generally includes a GelSeal® cap and a wound protector/retractor. The wound protector/retractor is configured to extend through an incision site to patient cavity **6020** and the GelSeal® cap provides a seal for the wound protector/retractor. As will also be understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art, GelSeal® cap may comprise a penetrable material that permits the insertion of one or more other medical appliances (e.g., trocar **6022**, a scalpel, etc.). In some embodiments, through appropriate tubing and/or sleeves, insufflation fluid may be introduced into patient cavity **6020** and smoke may be removed from patient cavity **6020** through GelSeal® cap.

(59) As shown in FIG. 9, only GelSeal® cap **6402** of the GelPort is visible. This disclosure recognizes that primary pressure sensor **6022** may be included or added onto GelSeal® cap **6402** in a manner that permits pressure readings to be taken with respect to patient cavity **6020**. As discussed above, primary pressure sensor **6022** or backup sensor **6026** may be coupled to a device (e.g., an insufflator **6010**, a visual display) via wired connection **6025**. In some embodiments, wired connection **6025** includes sheathing **6404** to shield wired connection **6025** from electromagnetic frequencies. All or a part of wired connection **6025** may be shielded. As illustrated in FIG. 9, wired connection **6025** is shielded by sheath **6404** and is coupled to backup sensor **6026** which provides a backup pressure measurement for primary pressure sensor **6022**.

(60) This disclosure also describes and illustrates measuring pressure in a patient cavity using one or more pressure sensors. In some embodiments, the one or more pressure sensors are employed in, on, or through medical appliances such as trocars. As will be understood by one of ordinary skill in the art, this disclosure anticipates employing pressure sensors in, on, or through any suitable trocar. In certain embodiments, one or more pressure sensors are employed in, on, or through trocars described and illustrated in U.S. application Ser. No. 14/792,873.

(61) FIGS. 10A and 10B illustrate one embodiment of a system **7100** to supply an insufflation fluid **7102** to a patient cavity **7104** that uses a trocar having an inner lumen and an outer lumen in which the outer lumen allows for the insufflation fluid to be delivered to the patient cavity and the inner lumen provides a path for smoke to be removed from the patient cavity.

(62) System **7100** includes a trocar **7106**, an insufflation fluid source **7170**, a vacuum source **7180**, a conduit **7175** for supplying insufflation fluid **7102** to a portion of trocar **7106**, and a conduit **7185** for applying a vacuum from vacuum source **7124** to a portion of trocar **7106**. A distal end **7162** of trocar **7106** is inserted into patient cavity **7104** while the proximal end **7164** allows an instrument **7126** to be inserted such that trocar **7106** provides access to body cavity **7104** for the instruments **7126**. Suitable seals may be positioned in or around trocar **7106** for preventing or reducing leakage of fluid out of trocar **7106**. Patient cavity **7104** may be accessed through an incision made with an obturator, which may be included in the same kit or package with trocars described herein.

(63) Trocar **7106** is formed with an inner lumen **7108** and an outer lumen **7110**. Inner lumen **7108** is separated from outer lumen **7110** by an inner wall **7125**. Outer lumen **7110** is surrounded by an outer wall **7118**. Outer wall **7118** may be formed with one or more holes or apertures **7114** near a distal end **7162** of trocar **7106**. A surgical instrument **7126** may be positioned within inner lumen **7108** to allow access to patient cavity **7104** by a surgeon using surgical instrument **7126**. An open gas tubing connection **7120** couples inner lumen **7108** to conduit **7185**. Open gas tubing connection **7120** may include a vacuum break **7166**. Tubing **7175** couples insufflation fluid source **7170** to outer lumen **7110** by connection **7164**.

(64) In operation, insufflation fluid **7102** is delivered to patient cavity **7104** from insufflation fluid

source **7170** through conduit **7175** and outer lumen **7110**, as indicated by arrows **7112**. Insufflation fluid **7102** enters patient cavity **7104** via apertures **7114** in outer wall **7118** of the trocar **7106**.

(65) Smoke is sometimes present in patient cavity **104** due to electrocautery and other techniques (e.g. harmonic scalpels), and it is often desirable to remove such smoke from patient cavity **7104**. The teachings of the disclosure recognize deficiencies associated with using a second trocar for smoke removal in addition to the trocar used to provide insufflation fluid to the patient.

(66) Inner lumen **7108** of trocar **7106** allows for smoke in patient cavity **7104** to be removed using the same trocar **106** as is used for supplying insufflation fluid **7102** to patient cavity **7104**. Smoke is removed through inner lumen **7108** via connection **7120**, which couples inner lumen **7108** to conduit **7185**, as indicated by arrows **7122**. The smoke from patient cavity **7104** enters inner lumen **7108** through an opening at distal end **7162** of trocar **7106**. The smoke can be vented into the operating room, filtered into the operating room, or vented out of the operating room via a vacuum source **7124**. Inner lumen **7108** also allows for insertion of a surgical instrument **7126** at the same time as smoke is being removed.

(67) Thus, trocar **7106** allows for supplying insufflation fluid **7102** to a patient cavity **7104** and removing smoke from the patient cavity **7104** without the use of multiple trocars **7106**. Additional embodiments of systems and methods that allow supplying insufflation fluid **7102** to patient cavity **7104** along with cavity pressure measurement and/or smoke removal are described below in conjunction with FIGS. 2A through 7B. Additional details of certain portions of the described systems and methods are provided after the description of FIG. 16B.

(68) FIGS. 11A and 11B illustrate one embodiment of a system **7200** to supply an insufflation fluid **7102** to a patient cavity **7104** that uses a trocar having an inner lumen and an outer lumen in which the inner lumen allows for the insufflation fluid to be delivered to the patient cavity and the outer lumen provides a path for smoke to be removed from the patient cavity.

(69) System **7200** includes a trocar **7206** having an inner lumen **7208** and an outer lumen **7210**. Trocar **7206** is analogous to trocar **7106**, with analogous portions having analogous reference numerals. System **7200** is analogous to system **7100**, except that insufflation fluid **7102** is supplied to patient cavity **7104** via inner lumen **7208**, rather than outer lumen **7110** as in system **7100**, and smoke is removed from patient cavity **7104** via outer lumen **7210** rather than inner lumen **7108** as in system **7100**. As such, system **7200** includes an open gas tubing connection **7220** between conduit **7185** and outer lumen. Connection **7220** is adapted to connect conduit **7185** to outer lumen **7210**. And system **7200** includes a connection **7264** between conduit **7175** and inner lumen **7208** adapted to connect conduit **7175** to inner lumen **7208**.

(70) In operation, insufflation fluid **7102** is delivered to patient cavity **7104** from insufflation fluid source **7170** through conduit **7175** and inner lumen **7208**, as indicated by arrows **7212**. Insufflation fluid **7102** enters patient cavity **7104** via an opening at distal end **7262** of trocar **7206**. Inner lumen **7208** also allows for the insertion surgical instrument **7126** at the same time as insufflation fluid **7102** is being delivered.

(71) Outer lumen **7210** of trocar **7206** allows for smoke in patient cavity **7104** to be removed using the same trocar **7206** as is used for supplying insufflation fluid **7102** to patient cavity **7104**. Smoke is removed through outer lumen inner **7210** via connection **7220**, which couples outer lumen **7210** to conduit **7185**, as indicated by arrows **7222**. The smoke from patient cavity **7104** enters outer lumen **7210** through apertures **7214** in an outer wall **7218** of trocar **7206**.

(72) The smoke can be vented into the operating room, filtered into the operating room, or vented out of the operating room via a vacuum source **7124**.

(73) FIGS. 12A and 12B illustrate one embodiment of a system **7300** to supply an insufflation fluid **7102** to a patient cavity **7104** that uses a trocar having an inner lumen and an outer lumen with a plurality of chambers in which one of the chambers in the outer lumen allows for the insufflation fluid to be delivered to the patient cavity and the other chamber in the outer lumen provides a path for smoke to be removed from the patient cavity.

(74) System **7300** includes a trocar **7306**. Trocar **7306** is analogous to trocar **7106**, with analogous portions having analogous reference numerals, except that trocar **7306** is formed with an inner lumen **7308** and an outer lumen **7310** having a plurality of chambers **7330**, **7332**. Outer wall **7318** is formed with one or more holes or apertures **7314** near a distal end **7362** of trocar **7306** that are associated with chamber **7330**. Outer wall **7118** may also be formed with one or more holes or apertures **7315** proximate distal end **7362** of trocar **7306** that are associated with chamber **7332**. System **7300** is analogous to system **7100**, with analogous portions having analogous reference numerals, except that system **7300** includes an open gas tubing connection **7320** adapted to connect to chamber **7332** of outer lumen **7310** to conduit **7185**. And, system **7300** includes a connection **7364** adapted to connect conduit **7312** to chamber **7330** of outer lumen **7310**.

(75) In operation, insufflation fluid **7102** is delivered to patient cavity **7104** from insufflation fluid source **7170** through conduit **7175** and chamber **7330** of outer lumen **7310**, as indicated by arrows **7312**. Insufflation fluid **7102** enters patient cavity **7104** via apertures **7314** in an outer wall **7318** of the trocar **7106**.

(76) The other chamber in outer lumen **7310**, chamber **7332**, allows for smoke in patient cavity **7104** to be removed using the same trocar **7306** as is used for supplying insufflation fluid **7102** to patient cavity **7104**. Smoke is removed through chamber **7332** of outer lumen **7310** via connection **7320**, which couples chamber **7332** of outer lumen **7308** to conduit **7185**, as indicated by arrows **7322**. The smoke from patient cavity **104** enters chamber **7332** of outer lumen **7108** through apertures **7315** in outer wall **7318** of trocar **7306**. The smoke can be vented into the operating room, filtered into the operating room, or vented out of the operating room via a vacuum source **7124**.

(77) Inner lumen **7308** allows for insertion of surgical instrument **7126** at the same time as smoke is being removed and/or at the same time insufflation fluid is being supplied to patient cavity **7104**.

(78) FIGS. **13A** and **13B** illustrate one embodiment of a system **7400** to supply an insufflation fluid **7102** to a patient cavity **7104** that uses a trocar having an inner lumen and an outer lumen with a plurality of chambers in which one of the chambers in the outer lumen allows for the insufflation fluid to be delivered to the patient cavity and the other chamber in the outer lumen allows pressure measurement of the patient cavity.

(79) System **7400** of FIGS. **13A** and **13b** is analogous to system **7300** of FIGS. **12A** and **12B**, except that chamber **7432** of outer lumen **7410** is used to effect pressure measurement of patient cavity **7104**, as opposed to chamber **7332** being used to remove smoke from patient cavity **7104**. As such system **7400** includes a monitor **7460** for measuring pressure that is connected to trocar **7406** by a suitable conduit **7495** for such a pressure measurement. Connection **7420** couples conduit **7495** to inner lumen chamber **7432**. Trocar **7406** is analogous to trocar **7306**, with analogous portions having analogous reference numerals. Connection **7464** may be adapted to couple outer chamber **7432** to conduit **7185**.

(80) In operation, insufflation fluid **7102** is delivered to patient cavity **7104** from insufflation fluid source **7170** through conduit **7175** and chamber **7430** of outer lumen **7410**, as indicated by arrows **7412**. Insufflation fluid **7102** enters patient cavity **7104** via apertures **7414** in an outer wall **7418** of the trocar **7406**.

(81) The other outer lumen chamber, chamber **7432**, allows for pressure measurement by creating a direct connection from patient cavity **7104** through apertures **7415** to a monitor **7460** external to the patient, as illustrated by bi-directional arrows **7450**. The direct connection has a minimal pressure drop to ensure accurate measurement. Outer lumen **7410** may or may not be connected to inner lumen **7408** via one or more holes **7452** in inner wall **7425**.

(82) FIGS. **14A** and **14B** illustrate one embodiment of a system **7500** to supply an insufflation fluid **7102** to a patient cavity **7104** that uses a trocar having an inner lumen and an outer lumen with a plurality of chambers in which one of the chambers in the outer lumen allows for the insufflation fluid to be delivered to the patient cavity, the other chamber in the outer lumen provides a path for

smoke to be removed from the patient cavity, and the inner lumen allows pressure measurement of the patient cavity.

(83) System **7500** includes trocar **7506**, which is analogous to trocar **7306**, with analogous portions having analogous reference numerals. System **7500** is analogous to system **7300** except for the addition of pressure measurement system **7460** coupled by a conduit **7595** and connection **7598** to inner lumen **7508** of trocar **7506**. Connection **7598** may be any suitable connection for coupling inner lumen **7508** to conduit **7595**.

(84) In operation, system **7500** performs similarly to system **7300**. In particular, insufflation fluid **7102** is delivered to patient cavity **7104** from insufflation fluid source **7170** through conduit **7175** and chamber **7530** of outer lumen **7510**, as indicated by arrows **7512**. Insufflation fluid **7102** enters patient cavity **7104** via apertures **7514** in an outer wall **7518** of the trocar **7506**.

(85) The other chamber in outer lumen **7510**, chamber **7532**, allows for smoke in patient cavity **7104** to be removed using the same trocar **7506** as is used for supplying insufflation fluid **7102** to patient cavity **7104**. Smoke is removed from patient cavity **7104** through apertures **7515** through chamber **7532** of outer lumen **7510** via connection **7520**, which couples chamber **7532** of outer lumen **7508** to conduit **7585**, as indicated by arrows **7522**. The smoke from patient cavity **7104** enters chamber **7532** of outer lumen **7108** through aperture **7515** in outer wall **7518** of trocar **7506**. The smoke can be vented into the operating room, filtered into the operating room, or vented out of the operating room via a vacuum source **7124**.

(86) In addition, inner lumen chamber **7508** allows for pressure measurement by creating a direct connection from patient cavity **7104** to a monitor **7460** external to the patient, as indicated by bi-directional arrows **7550**. The direct connection has a minimal pressure drop to ensure accurate measurement.

(87) FIGS. **15A** and **15B** illustrate one embodiment of a system **7600** to supply an insufflation fluid **7102** to a patient cavity **7104** that uses a trocar having an inner lumen and an outer lumen in which the outer lumen allows for the insufflation fluid to be delivered to the patient cavity and the inner lumen allows pressure measurement of the patient cavity.

(88) System **7500** includes trocar **7506**, which is analogous to trocar **7106**, with analogous portions having analogous reference numerals. System **7600** is analogous to system **7100**, with analogous portions having analogous reference numerals, except that system **7600** includes monitor **7460** for measuring pressure. System **7600** also includes a suitable connection **7620** for such pressure measurement that couples inner lumen **7608** of trocar **7606** to conduit **7185**.

(89) In operation, insufflation fluid **7102** is delivered to patient cavity **7104** from insufflation fluid source **7170** through conduit **7175** and outer lumen **7610**, as indicated by arrows **7612**. Insufflation fluid **7102** enters patient cavity **7104** via apertures **7614** in outer wall **7618** of the trocar **7606**.

(90) Inner lumen **7608** allows for pressure measurement by creating a direct connection from patient cavity **7104** to a monitor **7460** external to the patient, as indicated by bi-directional arrows **7650**. The direct connection has a minimal pressure drop to ensure accurate measurement.

(91) FIGS. **16A** and **16B** illustrate one embodiment of a system to supply an insufflation fluid to a patient cavity that uses a trocar having an inner lumen and an outer lumen with a plurality of chambers in which one of the chambers in the outer lumen allows for the insufflation fluid to be delivered to the patient cavity, the other chamber in the outer lumen allows pressure measurement of the patient cavity, and the inner lumen provides a path for smoke to be removed from the patient cavity.

(92) System **7700** includes trocar **7706**, which is analogous to trocar **7506**, with analogous portions having analogous reference numerals. System **7700** is analogous to the system **7500** except that pressure measurement occurs through outer chamber **7732** of trocar **7700** as opposed to through inner lumen **7508** of system **7500**, and smoke is removed from patient cavity **7104** through inner lumen **7708** of trocar **7700** as opposed to through outer chamber **7552** of system **7500**. A connector **7721** couples conduit **7185** to inner lumen **7730**.

(93) In operation, insufflation fluid **7102** is delivered to patient cavity **7104** from insufflation fluid source **7170** through conduit **7175** and chamber **7730** of outer lumen **7710**, as indicated by arrows **7712**. Insufflation fluid **7102** enters patient cavity **7104** via apertures **7714** in an outer wall **7718** of the trocar **7706**.

(94) The other outer lumen chamber, chamber **7732**, allows for pressure measurement by creating a direct connection from patient cavity **7104** to a monitor **7460** external to the patient, as illustrated by bi-directional arrows **7750**. The direct connection has a minimal pressure drop to ensure accurate measurement. Outer lumen **7710** may or may not be connected to inner lumen **7708** via one or more holes **7752** in inner wall **7725**.

(95) Inner lumen **7708** allows for smoke to be removed via an open gas tubing connection **7721** to inner lumen **7708**. The smoke can be vented into the operating room, filtered into the operating room, or vented out of the operating room via vacuum source **7124**. Inner lumen **7708** also allows for the insertion of a surgical instrument **7126** at the same time as smoke is being removed.

(96) Thus, the systems of FIG. **10A** through **16B** allow removal of smoke and/or pressure measurements while also providing a path from an insufflation fluid to a patient cavity using a single trocar. In some embodiments this avoids the use of multiple trocars in a patient at the same time; however, the teachings of the present disclosure recognize that the described systems and methods may be used in conjunction with the use of multiple trocars if desired.

(97) Additional details of the systems described in FIGS. **10A-16B** are described below for insufflation fluid **7102**, insufflation fluid source **7170**, trocars **7106-7706**, open gas tubing connection **7120**, vacuum break **7166**, connection **7164**, conduit **7175**, conduit **7185**, vacuum source **7124**, and surgical instrument **126**.

(98) Insufflation fluid **7102** may be any suitable gas used for insufflation purposes. In one example, insufflation gas is carbon dioxide. Insufflation fluid source **7170** may be any suitable source of insufflation fluid **7102** at any suitable pressure.

(99) Trocar described and depicted in FIGS. **10-16** (trocars **7106**, **7206**, **7306**, **7406**, **7506**, **7606**, and **7707**) can be any suitable trocar that includes an inner and outer lumen as described herein. All trocars described herein may be open or closed at the distal end, as the application of the trocar would allow. Further the trocars may or may not include apertures in their inner wall separating the outer lumen from the inner lumen. Further all trocars described herein may be formed according to features described in the '219 patent, the '112 patent, and/or the '189 patent. Further, trocars **106-706** may be formed with a heater and/or humidifier therein.

(100) Vacuum break **7166** may be a flapper valve that remains closed when the patient cavity is under a pressure higher than the surrounding atmosphere. The closed valve will not allow insufflation fluid to leak into the atmosphere. When the pressure in patient cavity **7104** drops to atmospheric pressure or lower the flapper valve **7166** will open relieving most of the negative pressure within the body cavity.

(101) Conduit **7175** may be any suitable conduit for providing an insufflation fluid to a portion of a trocar. An example of conduit **7175** includes flexible PVC tubing.

(102) Conduit **7185** may be any suitable conduit for providing a vacuum to a portion of a trocar. An example of conduit **7185** is flexible PVC tubing.

(103) Vacuum source **7124** is any suitable device that can apply a relative negative pressure to a portion of a trocar for removal of smoke from a patient cavity. Examples of vacuum source **7124** include a stand-alone vacuum pump or a centralized hospital vacuum system.

(104) Surgical instrument **7126** may be any suitable instrument that may be used in surgery, including an obturator used to make an incision to obtain access to a body cavity.

(105) This disclosure further contemplates measuring the pressure of a body cavity when delivering insufflation fluid through one or more medical appliances. As one example, insufflation fluid may be delivered to the patient cavity through a trocar that is inserted through a medical port such as a GelPort. As described above in reference to FIG. **9**, a GelPort may include a seal (also referred to

herein as a “cap”) and a retractor. As is also described above in reference to FIG. 9, the seal may comprise a penetrable material that permits the insertion of one or more other medical appliances/instruments (e.g., trocar **6022**, a grasper, etc.) therethrough. Such an example is described and illustrated in reference to FIG. 17.

(106) FIG. 17 illustrates a system **1700** for delivering insufflation fluid to a patient cavity **1750** via a trocar **1720a** inserted through a multiple access port, such as a GelPort described above in reference to FIG. 9. As will be understood by one of ordinary skill in the art, real-time pressure sensing is of critical importance in certain medical procedures (e.g., TAMIS) procedures wherein the volume of insufflation is restricted given the size of the patient cavity. Inadvertent loss of insufflation during such procedures greatly affects the ability of a medical professional to explore and/or view the site to be treated or observed.

(107) One or more trocars **1720** (or other medical appliances) may be inserted through GelPort **1740** to provide an operator (e.g., a surgeon) with access to patient cavity **1750**. As shown in FIG. 17, three trocars **1720** (i.e., trocars **1720a**, **1720b**, and **1720c**) penetrate a seal **1742** of GelPort **1740** such that insufflation fluid and/or medical appliances/instruments (e.g., grasper, scope) reach a desired portion of patient cavity **1750**. In addition to seal **1742**, GelPort **1744** also includes, in some embodiments, a retractor **1744** configured to hold or maintain an incision site open to a desired level of openness.

(108) Similar to other insufflation delivery systems described and depicted herein, system **1700** includes at least one insufflator **1710**, a trocar **1720a**, and a conduit **1715** coupling insufflator **1710** to trocar **1720a** that facilitates delivery of insufflation fluid from insufflator **1710** to trocar **1720a**. System **1700** also includes one or more pressure sensors. As shown in FIG. 17, system **1700** includes pressure sensors **1712** and **1725**. Sensor **1712** may be disposed in, on, or through insufflator **1710** and be configured take pressure measurements indicative of a pressure of patient cavity **1750**. Sensor **1725** may be disposed in, on, or through trocar **1720a** and be configured take pressure measurements indicative of a pressure of patient cavity **1750**. Pressure sensor **1725** may be disposed in any suitable position in, on, or through trocar **1720a**, including but not limited to the positions described and depicted in FIGS. 2A-4B and FIG. 6. This disclosure also recognizes positioning pressure sensor **1725** in, on, or through any suitable chamber defined by walls of a trocar. For example, this disclosure contemplates positioning pressure sensor **1725** in, on, or through any of the following: an inner lumen of a trocar (e.g., inner lumen **108** of FIGS. 10A and 10B), an outer lumen of a trocar (e.g., outer lumen **110** of FIGS. 10A and 10B), or any partitioned portion of an outer lumen of a trocar (e.g., chambers **330** & **332** of FIG. 12B).

(109) In operation, an operator (e.g., a surgeon) penetrates seal **1742** of GelPort **1740** with a trocar (e.g., trocar **1720a**) and couples the penetrating trocar **1720a** to an insufflator **1710** using a conduit **1715** to ensure a fluid connection therebetween. The operator may then initiate insufflation of patient cavity **1750** using insufflator **1710**, wherein insufflation fluid is discharged from insufflator **1710** to conduit **1715**, which in turn directs the insufflation fluid through trocar **1720a**, which in turn delivers the insufflation fluid to patient cavity **1750**. As shown in FIG. 17, trocar **1720a** includes an inner lumen **1722** and an outer lumen **1724** and insufflation fluid is delivered to patient cavity **1750** via outer lumen **1724**. In particular embodiments, such as that illustrated in FIG. 17, insufflation fluid is delivered to patient cavity **1750** via a particular chamber (e.g., chamber **1724a**) of outer lumen **1724** (as indicated by the arrows in FIG. 17).

(110) In alternative embodiments, insufflation fluid may be directed from conduit **1715** to inner lumen **1722** of trocar **1720a** before being delivered to patient cavity **1750**. Given that inner lumen **1722** may also accommodate one or more medical instruments (e.g., a grasper), trocar **1720a** may also include a suitable seal through which an instrument is inserted to limit or restrict the escape of insufflation fluid from the proximal end of trocar **1720a**.

(111) As described above, operators (and or assistants thereof) monitor the pressure of a patient cavity to ensure the patient cavity **1750** is properly insufflated when performing a surgical

procedure. These pressure measurements may be taken by pressure sensors **1710** and/or **1725**. In some embodiments, one pressure sensor (e.g., sensor **1725**) may serve as a primary sensor and another pressure sensor (e.g., sensor **1710**) may serve as a backup sensor such that insufflator **1710** supplies insufflation fluid to patient cavity **1750** based on pressure measurements taken by sensor **1725** unless and until sensor **1725** is determined to be inaccurate or otherwise unreliable. Upon making such determination, insufflator **1710** may supply insufflation fluid to patient cavity **1750** based on pressure measurements taken by sensor **1710**. In some other embodiments, sensor **1710** may be the primary pressure sensor and sensor **1725** may be the backup pressure sensor.

(112) FIG. **18** illustrates a method **1800** of delivering insufflation fluid to a patient cavity using system **1700** of FIG. **17**. In some embodiments, the method **1800** begins at a step **1805** and continues to a step **1810**. At step **1810**, system **1700** receives a pressure measurement indicative of a pressure of patient cavity **1850**. In some embodiments, the pressure measurement is taken by a pressure sensor (e.g., pressure sensor **1810**, **1825**). The sensor taking such measurement may be a primary and/or backup pressure sensor. As described above, the component of system **1700** that receives the pressure measurement may, in certain embodiments, be insufflator **1710**. As described in reference to FIG. **7A**, insufflator **1710** may include components (e.g., memory, processor, interfaces) necessary to receive, and act on, pressure measurement information. Upon completion of step **1810**, the method **1800** may proceed to a step **1820**.

(113) At step **1820**, system **1700** controls a supply of insufflation fluid to patient cavity **1750** based on the pressure measurement received at step **1710**. In some embodiments, the component of system **1700** that executes step **1820** is insufflator **1710**. In such embodiments, a processor of insufflator **1710** may execute step **1820**. Upon completion of step **1820**, the method **1800** may proceed to a step **1830**.

(114) At step **1830**, system **1700** delivers the supplied insufflation fluid to patient cavity **1750** via access port **1740**. In some embodiments, the component that delivers the insufflation fluid to patient cavity **1750** is trocar **1720a**. As described above, trocar **1720a** may be configured to penetrate a seal **1742** of access port **1740**, thereby providing a flow path for the insufflation fluid from trocar **1720a** to patient cavity **1750**. In some embodiments, the insufflation fluid is directed through an inner lumen (e.g., lumen **1722**) of trocar **1720a** and is discharged into patient cavity **1750**. In other embodiments, the insufflation fluid is directed through an outer lumen (e.g., lumen **1724**) (or a chamber thereof) of trocar **1720a** and is discharged into patient cavity **1750**. Upon completion of step **1830**, the method **1800** may proceed to an end step **1835**.

(115) In some embodiments, method **1800** may include only a subset of the steps described above. In other embodiments, method **1800** may include steps in addition to those described above. As an example, method **1800** may include one or more of the following steps: (1) directing, by conduit **1715**, the insufflation fluid from insufflator **1710** to trocar **1720a**; (2) determining, by a sensor other than the one that took the pressure measurement at step **1810**, a pressure measurement indicative of a pressure of the patient cavity; (3) determining, by insufflator **1710**, that the pressure measurement taken at step **1810** is inaccurate or otherwise unreliable; and (4) controlling the supply of the insufflation fluid by insufflator **1710** to patient cavity **1850** based on the pressure measurement determined by the other sensor identified in preceding additional step (2).

(116) Although FIGS. **1-18** have been described above as including particular steps and/or components, the method and systems of these FIGURES may include any combination of any of the described steps and/or components and any of the options or features described herein, as would be understood by one of ordinary skill in the art. For example, any of the steps, options, or features described in reference to one figure may be utilized in combination with any number of other steps, options, or features described in reference to another figure, as would be understood by one of ordinary skill in the art.

(117) Although the embodiments in the disclosure have been described in detail, numerous changes, substitutions, variations, alterations, and modifications may be ascertained by those

skilled in the art. It is intended that the present disclosure encompass all such changes, substitutions, variations, alterations, and modifications. Additionally, one or more features described herein may be combined with one or more embodiments also described herein. For example, a primary and/or a backup sensor as described above and illustrated in reference to FIGS. 2A-8 may be combined with the trocars shown and described with reference to FIGS. 10A-16B. As another example, the trocars illustrated and described with reference to FIGS. 10A-16B may also be combined with the system described and illustrated in FIG. 17 (e.g., replace trocar 1720a of FIG. 17 with trocar 7600 of FIG. 15a). As yet another example, the system described and illustrated in FIG. 17 may incorporate features from FIGS. 2A-8 (e.g., sensor 1725 of FIG. 17 may be repositioned/relocated in, on, or through trocar as illustrated and described in FIGS. 2a-6).

Claims

1. A system comprising: an insufflator configured to supply insufflation fluid to a patient cavity, the insufflator comprising a processor and a computer-readable media having logic stored thereon; an access port comprising a cap and a retractor, the access port facilitating access therethrough to the patient cavity; a primary pressure sensor located in or on the access port and configured to determine a pressure measurement indicative of a pressure of the patient cavity; a conduit configured to facilitate delivery of the insufflation fluid to the patient cavity via the access port; wherein: the insufflator is communicatively coupled to the primary pressure sensor; and the logic stored on the computer-readable media is configured, when executed on the processor, to: receive the pressure measurement from the primary pressure sensor; and control the supply of the insufflation fluid to the patient cavity based on the pressure measurement from the primary pressure sensor.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein at least a portion of the conduit is configured to penetrate a seal of the access port thereby directing the insufflation fluid to the patient cavity.
3. The system of claim 1, wherein the conduit comprises a first end and a second end, wherein the first end is coupled to the insufflator and the second end is coupled to the access port.
4. The system of claim 1, wherein the conduit comprises an outer tubular member disposed about an inner tubular member, wherein the inner tubular member is separated from the outer tubular member by an inner wall.
5. The system of claim 4, wherein the outer tubular member is partitioned into at least a first chamber and a second chamber, wherein: the first chamber is separated from the second chamber; and the first chamber and the second chamber are defined by the inner wall and an outer wall of the outer tubular member.
6. The system of claim 4, wherein the insufflation fluid is delivered to the patient cavity via the outer tubular member.
7. The system of claim 4, wherein the insufflation fluid is delivered to the patient cavity via the inner tubular member.
8. The system of claim 1, wherein the conduit comprises a backup pressure sensor.
9. The system of claim 1, wherein the insufflator comprises a backup pressure sensor.
10. The system of claim 1, wherein the system further comprises a backup pressure sensor communicatively coupled to the insufflator, the backup pressure sensor being configured to determine a pressure measurement indicative of a pressure of the patient cavity.
11. The system of claim 10, wherein the logic stored on the computer-readable media is further configured, when executed on the processor, to: determine that the pressure measurement from the primary pressure sensor is inaccurate and, in response, control the supply of the insufflation fluid by the insufflator to the patient cavity based on the pressure measurement determined by the backup pressure sensor rather than the pressure measurement determined by the primary pressure sensor.

12. A method of supplying insufflation fluid to a patient cavity, the method comprising: receiving, from a primary pressure sensor, a pressure measurement indicative of a pressure of a patient cavity; controlling, by an insufflator, a supply of the insufflation fluid to the patient cavity based on the pressure measurement from the primary pressure sensor; and delivering, by a conduit, the supplied insufflation fluid to the patient cavity via an access port, wherein: the primary pressure sensor is located in or on the access port; the access port comprises a seal and a retractor; and the access port facilitates access therethrough to the patient cavity.
13. The method of claim 12, wherein delivering the insufflation fluid via the access port comprises penetrating, by at least a portion of the conduit, the seal of the access port to permit access therethrough to the patient cavity.
14. The method of claim 12, further comprising: directing, by the conduit, the insufflation fluid from the insufflator to the conduit.
15. The method of claim 12, wherein delivering the insufflation fluid to the patient cavity comprises directing the insufflation fluid through an outer tubular member of the conduit, wherein the outer tubular member is disposed about an inner tubular member, the inner tubular member being separated from the outer tubular member by an inner wall.
16. The method of claim 15, wherein delivering the insufflation fluid to the patient cavity comprises directing the insufflation fluid through a first or a second chamber of the outer tubular member, wherein the first chamber is separated from the second chamber and the first chamber and the second chamber are defined by the inner wall and an outer wall of the outer tubular member.
17. The method of claim 12, wherein delivering the insufflation fluid to the patient cavity comprises directing the insufflation fluid through an inner tubular member of the conduit, wherein: the conduit further comprises an outer tubular member disposed about the inner tubular member, the inner tubular member being separated from the outer tubular member by an inner wall.
18. The method of claim 12, wherein a backup pressure sensor is comprised within one of the insufflator or the conduit.
19. The method of claim 12, further comprising determining, by a backup pressure sensor, a pressure measurement indicative of a pressure of the patient cavity.
20. The method of claim 19, further comprising: in response to determining that the pressure measurement from the primary pressure sensor is inaccurate controlling the supply of the insufflation fluid by the insufflator to the patient cavity based on the pressure measurement determined by the backup pressure sensor rather than the pressure measurement determined by the primary pressure sensor.
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